
Evaluate Business Needs

Based on a given integration requirement, identify and classify data into Confidential/Secure/Public.

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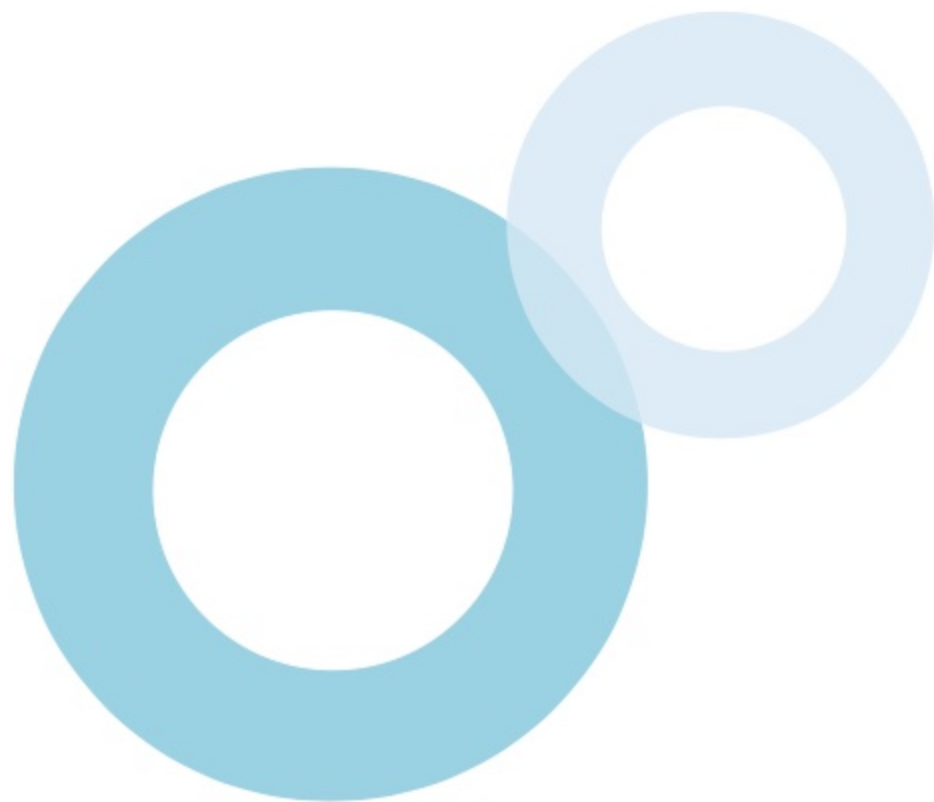
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After studying this topic, you should be able to:

-  Determine what data classification is and how an organization can benefit from it
-  Determine the functionality in Salesforce that is used to support data classification
-  Identify a few of the compliance acts, definitions, or regulations and associated data



Introduction

It is highly important for an organization to be knowledgeable of the data that it stores and uses in its day-to-day operations. Depending on the **location** of the **business entity** or **residence** of the **customers** who contribute to data in the org, there are **legal obligations** that require the organization to keep data **confidential** and **secure**. Examples of these data protection and privacy laws are the **General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)** that is used to protect personal data of EU residents, or the **Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA)** in the US to protect healthcare information. Salesforce allows specifying the data sensitivity of a field to indicate whether the data it holds should be treated as **confidential, secure or encrypted**, or **public**. Data classification requires an organization to define the org's schema and identify the risk and sensitivity of each data, and Salesforce provides tools to make the process easier.



Data Classification Field Metadata

COMPLIANCE CATEGORIZATION

Used to indicate the specific compliance acts, definitions, or regulations that are relevant to the data contained in the field



FIELD USAGE

Used to indicate whether the field is actively being used, can be removed, or is (or should be) hidden from users in the org



DATA SENSITIVITY

Used to indicate the data sensitivity level of the field and the risk associated with the data if it is lost or publicly exposed



DATA OWNER

Used to indicate the user or group who is accountable for the classification, security, and quality of the data in the field

Data Classification

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Data Classification

Salesforce provides native capabilities for classifying data in the org. Information on the classification of data determine aspects related to **access**, **reporting**, and **data compliance**.

❖ FIELD-LEVEL ATTRIBUTES

Field-level attributes or field metadata exist on each standard or custom object and are used to track the data classification of each field. These data classification fields are **Compliance Categorization**, **Data Sensitivity Level**, **Field Usage**, and **Data Owner**.

❖ DATA CLASSIFICATION VALUES

Not all data classification fields can be updated using the **Object Manager**. In this case, the **Data Classification Upload** tool in Setup or the **CustomField Metadata API** can be used. Furthermore, these tools allow updating of the field values in bulk.



Data Classification

Salesforce provides native capabilities for classifying data in the org. Information on the classification of data determine aspects related to **access**, **reporting**, and **data compliance**.

❖ PICKLIST VALUES

Compliance Categorization and **Data Sensitivity** picklist value sets can be customized in **Data Classification Settings** in Setup. To customize the **Field Usage** picklist value set, updating the **FieldBusinessStatus** picklist using the *StandardValueSet Metadata API* type is required.

❖ DEFAULT SENSITIVITY

Salesforce provides the “**Use default data sensitivity level option**” in the Data Classification Settings which, when enabled, will automatically set default values to the **Data Sensitivity Level** fields of objects in the org.



Data Classification Fields

The following shows the data classification field metadata on the **Email** field of the **Contact** object. The same set of fields exists for all standard/custom objects in the org.

The screenshot displays the 'Edit Contact Field' interface for the 'Email' field. The left sidebar contains navigation links: Details, Fields & Relationships (selected), Page Layouts, Lightning Record Pages, Buttons, Links, and Actions, Compact Layouts, Field Sets, Object Limits, Record Types, Related Lookup Filters, Search Layouts, List View Button Layout, and Slack Record Layouts. The main content area is titled 'Edit Contact Field Email' and includes a 'Back to Contact Fields' link. A 'Help for this Page' icon is in the top right. The 'Field Definition Edit' section has 'Save' and 'Cancel' buttons. Below this is the 'Field Information' section, which contains the following fields:

	Field Label	Email	Data Type	Email
Field Name	Email			
Data Owner	User			
Field Usage	--None--			
Data Sensitivity Level	--None--			
Compliance Categorization	Available PII HIPAA GDPR PCI ▶ ◀ Chosen			
Description				
Help Text				

At the bottom of the 'Field Information' section are 'Save' and 'Cancel' buttons.

Data Classification Upload

The **Data Classification Upload tool** in Setup can be used to update data classification values in bulk by **uploading a CSV file**.

The screenshot shows the Salesforce Setup interface for the Data Classification Upload tool. On the left is a navigation sidebar with a search bar containing 'Data Classification'. Below the search bar, a dropdown menu is open for 'Data Classification', showing three options: 'Data Classification Download', 'Data Classification Settings', and 'Data Classification Upload', which is currently selected and highlighted. Below the menu, a message reads: 'Didn't find what you're looking for? Try using Global Search.'

The main content area has a header with a gear icon, the word 'SETUP', and the title 'Data Classification Upload'. Below the header, the page title is 'Data Classification Upload' followed by 'Upload data classification values'. A 'Help for this Page' link with a question mark icon is in the top right corner.

The main body contains the following text: 'You can upload your data classification information from a .csv file.' This is followed by a bold instruction: 'Each row must include the entity name, field name, and data sensitivity level.' Below this, it says 'Here are examples of valid rows from a .csv file.' and lists two examples: 'Contact,Birthdate,Confidential' and 'Account,AnnualRevenue,MissionCritical'.

A red rectangular box highlights a section containing the text 'The max number of rows in one .csv file is 10,000.' Below this text are two buttons: 'Choose File' and 'No file chosen' (which is disabled). Below these buttons is another button labeled 'Import File'.

To the right of the main content area, there is a yellow callout box with a black border containing the text: 'A .csv file can be downloaded using the **Data Classification Download** tool to download existing data classification information that can be used as a template for uploading data classification values.'

Data Classification

Salesforce provides native capabilities for classifying data in the org. Information on the classification of data determine aspects related to **access**, **reporting**, and **data compliance**.

❖ COMPLIANCE

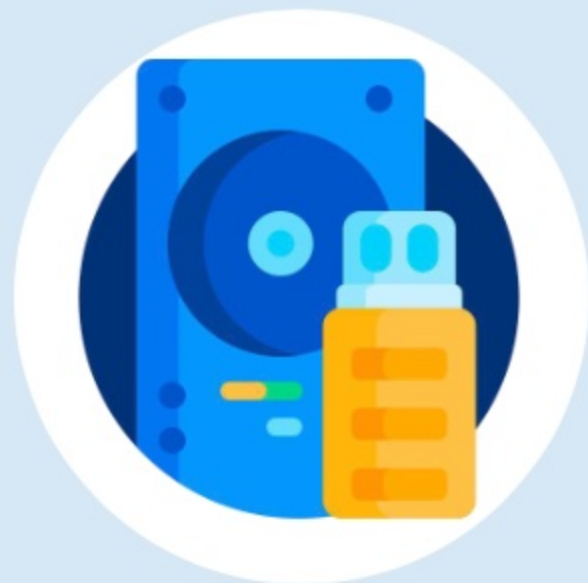
Data classification helps in ensuring that a business is compliant to **data privacy laws** and **regulations** that are applicable to data that is hosted on the org.

❖ DATA BACK-UP

Back-up processes can determine prioritization based on the **sensitivity level** and **compliance categorization** specified in each object field.

❖ DATA RETENTION

Data classification helps determine how long data can be **retained** in the org or when to **archive or delete** it.



Data Classification

Salesforce provides native capabilities for classifying data in the org. Information on the classification of data determine aspects related to **access**, **reporting**, and **data compliance**.

❖ FIELD ACCESS

Field-level security and/or **data encryption** using Classic Encryption or Shield Platform Encryption can be configured based on data classification.

❖ EVENT MONITORING

How users **access** and **interact** with data that are specified as sensitive can be **monitored**. For example, an alert can be triggered when a user exports data that contains sensitive information.

❖ DATA REPORTING

Reports can be created to comply with the organization's **data management policies** or **internal procedures**. Creating a **report type** that uses the **Entity Definition** as the primary object is required.



Data Classification Attributes

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Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

◆ GDPR

The **General Data Protection Regulation** (GDPR) is a comprehensive **data protection law** that regulates how organizations handle **personal data of EU residents** and ensure that users have **control** over the collected data. It requires **at least one** of its lawful bases to be satisfied to allow an entity to collect and process user data. One of the bases that is most commonly used by entities is requiring consent from the data subject, or the user, and ensuring that the data to be obtained is freely given, specific, informed, and unambiguous. GDPR protects personal information such as **gender, birthdate, address, hobbies** and **interests** and sensitive information such as **racial** or **ethnic origin, political opinions, religious/philosophical beliefs, health information, sexual orientation, genetic/biometric data**, and more.



Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

❖ CCPA

The **California Consumer Privacy Act** (CCPA) in the United States (US) secures the rights of users, for example, to know the **personal information** that is collected from them, how the data is **used** and **shared**, and allow them to **delete** that data. Informally considered as California's version of the GDPR, it is a comprehensive data protection regulation used to secure data such as **social security numbers, email addresses, telephone numbers, purchasing & consuming histories, disability status, genetic status**, and more.



Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

❖ HIPAA

The **Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act** (HIPAA) is a federal law for securing the **health information** of an individual (known as protected health information or **PHI**) in the US and ensure that data is **disclosed** only with the **patient's prior consent** or **knowledge**. HIPAA requires that individually identifiable health information is kept **confidential** and **readily accessible** whenever required by authorized people, group, or entities.



Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

❖ COPPA

The **Children's Online Privacy and Protection Act** (COPPA) requires that an organization should provide a **notice** and get **parental consent** before collecting data from **children** (under the age of 13) and ensure that the data is kept **confidential** and **secure**. This national privacy law in the US ensures that collected data is **disclosed** to parents and **can be deleted** whenever requested.



Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

❖ PCI

The **Payment Card Industry** (PCI) definition is used to indicate that stored information contains highly-sensitive data used in the payment card industry such as **credit card details, card holder information**, etc. and require the organization to be compliant to the **PCI Data Security Standard (PCI DSS)**, which is developed by an independent body created by Visa, MasterCard, American Express, Discover, and JCB. The PCI DSS requires that access to cardholder data is **restricted, tracked** and **monitored**, and that the data should be **encrypted** in transit across open, public networks.

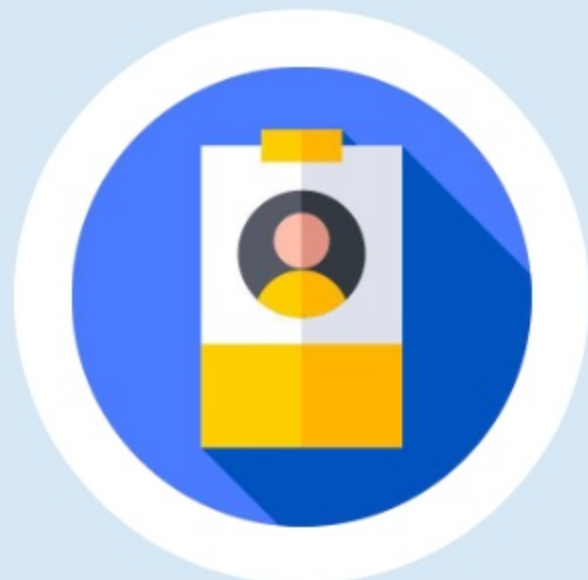


Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

❖ PII

Personal Identifiable Information (PII) refers to data that can be used to potentially identify a **specific individual**, or distinguish one person from another person. This categorization refers to data such as **social security number** (SSN), **taxpayer identification number** (TIN), **passport number**, **driver's license number**, **credit card number**, **personal contact number**, **home address**, **personal email address**, etc.

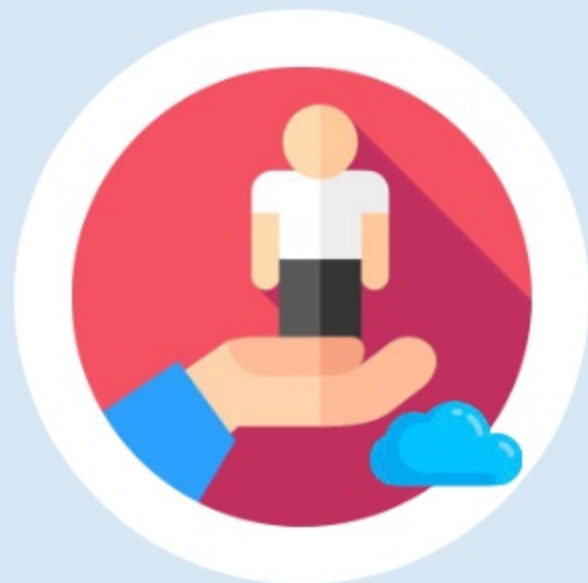


Compliance Categorization

The **Compliance Categorization** attribute is used to specify the **compliance acts, definitions, or regulations** that is relevant to the data stored in the field. The default values are described below:

❖ PersonalInfo

The PersonalInfo category is used to indicate that a field stores specific information of an external user in **Experience Cloud** and should be kept private and hidden from other **external users**. **Enhanced Personal Information Management** in Salesforce is used to prevent external users from accessing other user's personal information fields. By default, the Enhanced Personal Information Management tool hides, for example, the following fields, from other external users: **About Me, Address, Alias, Company Name, Department, Division, Email, Employee Number, Fax, Phone, Username**, and others.



Data Sensitivity Level

The **Data Sensitivity Level** attribute is used to indicate the **sensitivity of the data** stored in the field. The default values are:

❖ PUBLIC

This indicates that the field data can be **disclosed to the public** without any restrictions.

- Example: product details, street name, university courses, etc.

❖ INTERNAL

This indicates that the field data is available to **company employees** and **contractors** and is allowed to be shared with **customers**, **partners**, and people under a **non-disclosure agreement** (NDA).

- Example: internal memos, employee email address, budget, revenue projections, business strategies, etc.



Data Sensitivity Level

The **Data Sensitivity Level** attribute is used to indicate the **sensitivity of the data** stored in the field. The default values are:

❖ CONFIDENTIAL

This indicates that the field data should be available to an **approved group** of employees and contractors, but is **allowed to be shared** with customers, partners, and people under an NDA.

- Example: donor and alumni records, driver's license details, etc.

❖ RESTRICTED

This indicates that the field data should be available only to an **approved group** of company employees and contractors, and is **restricted** by law, regulation, an NDA or a company master service agreement (MSA).

- Example: social security numbers, payment card data, federal tax information, financial data, etc.



Data Sensitivity Level

The **Data Sensitivity Level** attribute is used to indicate the **sensitivity of the data** stored in the field. The default values are:

❖ MISSION CRITICAL

This indicates that the field data should be accessible only to a **small group** of approved employees and contractors, and is **restricted** by law, regulation, an NDA or a company master service agreement (MSA).

Mission-critical data should be **readily available** to authorized parties as failure or disruption of its availability will result in **serious or critical impact** to the business or organization.

- Example: emergency contact data, healthcare info, student records.



Field Usage

The **Field Usage** attribute is used to indicate whether the **field is being used** in the org. The default values are:

❖ ACTIVE

This indicates that the field is **being used** and **available** to users.

❖ DEPRECATE CANDIDATE

This indicates that the field is **no longer in use** and is going to be **deprecated**.

❖ HIDDEN

This indicates that the field is **not visible nor used** and may be **deprecated**.



Data Owner

The **Data Owner** attribute is used to indicate which entity in the org **“owns”** the referenced data.

❖ FIELD TYPE

The Data Owner attribute is a lookup field that references either a **User** or a **Public Group** in the current org.

❖ DATA OWNER

The data owner is a user or group that very well **understands** the data, recognizes its **importance** and **value**, and is responsible for its **classification, security**, and **quality**.



Business Scenario

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Business Scenario

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.



Cosmic Pharmaceuticals is a company that researches, develops, and distributes prescription drugs, and plans to expand its market across Europe and the US. It will be hiring more staff in addition to its 5,000 employees who interact with customers and patients of its partner hospitals and clinics to manage orders or inquiries, monitor product usage, and provide support.

Cosmic Pharmaceuticals uses Salesforce as their CRM mainly for managing accounts and business opportunities. It also separately runs a mobile app on the Heroku platform for their B2C processes.

The company wants to integrate Salesforce with their Heroku app to allow more accessibility yet enhanced security, confidentiality, integrity of healthcare data. As an integration requirement, data needs to be classified to ensure that the business complies with data regulation and laws as it expands to other countries.

Requirements & Solutions

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Requirement 1



SCENARIO

It is specified that data related to hospitals & clinics, patients and customers should be both stored in Salesforce and Heroku using data virtualization.

Organization data from the Heroku app such as the names of hospital and clinics, registration numbers, and contact numbers will be stored as Account records in Salesforce.

Furthermore, data of patients or customers will be stored as Contact records in Salesforce and hold information such as the name, home address, personal email address, insurance details, and certain health information.



Solution 1



SOLUTION

Hospital or clinic information such as **contact numbers** and **company registration numbers** are **non-personal data**. So, fields containing related information can be classified as public data and require no compliance obligations, for example, to the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) or Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA).

On the other hand, information such as a **full name**, **home address**, **email address**, **identification card number**, etc. are **personal data**. The company should ensure that they comply at the very least to the laws and policies enforced by the GDPR and HIPAA such as keeping customer or patient data secure and confidential, and allowing access only to authorized personnel or entities.



Requirement 2



SCENARIO

The customers or patients of Cosmic Pharmaceuticals use a mobile app that runs on the Heroku platform to order products, consult with medical professionals, track health conditions, report side effects, and other activities.

When integrating Heroku with Salesforce, the company needs to ensure that the solution is compliant to relevant data privacy and laws.



Solution 2



SOLUTION

The company should comply to **HIPAA**, for instance, when collecting healthcare information for customers from the US. To meet integration requirements, the Heroku instance can take advantage of HIPAA-compliant **Private Spaces** and **Heroku Shield Connect**. While Heroku Private Spaces is used to run apps in an isolated network and dedicated runtime environment making the app more **secure and reliable**, Heroku Shield Connect allows safe and encrypted synchronization of data between Heroku and Salesforce.

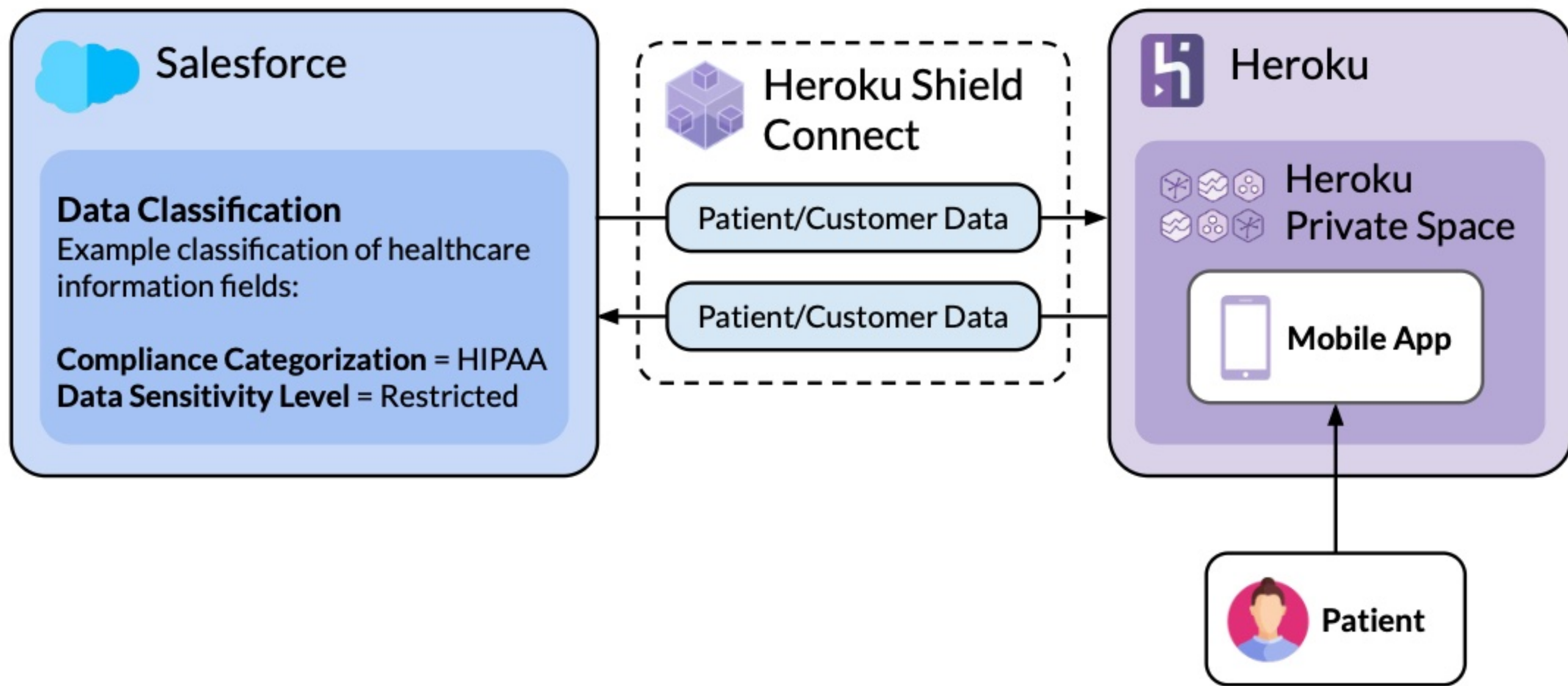
In Salesforce, fields that contain related healthcare information can be classified, but not limited to, as:

Compliance Categorization = HIPAA

Data Sensitivity Level = Restricted



Solution 2



Learn More

-  [Classify Sensitive Data to Support Data Management Policies](#)
-  [Data Protection and Privacy](#)
-  [Certifications, Standards and Regulations](#)
-  [Protect User PII Data with Enhanced Personal Information Management](#)